

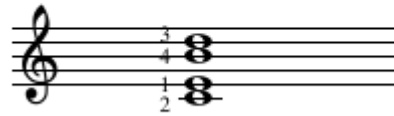
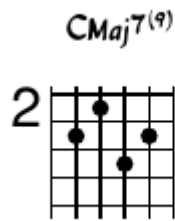
SBN TEACHING HUB · TOP 10

TOP10

Bossa Nova Chords

Essential Voicings for Guitar

01

**10 CATALOG ENTRIES**

Every chord is a movable shape — learn it once, play it in all 12 keys.

7 REAL SONGS

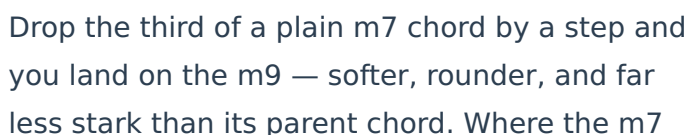
Every entry is cross-referenced to where it actually appears — Ipanema, Corcovado, Wave and more.

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1 SECRET WEAPON

Entry #7, the diminished 7th, is Tom Jobim's most-used passing chord in the whole songbook.

The little sister of the Major9 chord — a bit more mellow, and at least as beautiful.



The jazz bossa standard **Blue Bossa** makes extensive use of this chord — try comping through the changes slowly before bringing it up to tempo, and listen for how the ninth colours the line differently depending on what the melody is doing above it.

Blue Bossa —

TRY THIS

Play the pattern with your thumb only, then add fingerstyle arpeggiation once the shape feels secure.

RELATED

Compare with the plain m7 shell voicing (Shell Voicings booklet, p.1) — same family, different colour.

REPERTOIRE EXAMPLE · 1 OF 7

The Girl from Ipanema

Bars 1–8 · built entirely from three chords in this catalog

CHORDS USED **01** **Maj7(9)** **02** **m7(9)** **08** **Dom7(9)**

FMaj7(9) G7(9)

Tall and tan and young and love-ly, The Girl From Ipanema goes walk-ing, and when

T
A
B

8 8 8 8 8 8 10 10 10 10 10 10
9 9 9 9 9 9 10 10 10 10 10 10
7 7 7 7 7 7 9 9 9 9 9 9
8 8 8 8 8 8 10 10 10 10 10 10

01 **FMaj7(9)** **08** **G7(9)**

Almost the entire A section alternates between just two voicings from this catalog — entry 01 and entry 08. Once those two shapes are comfortable, this song is largely a rhythm exercise rather than a chord-memorisation one.